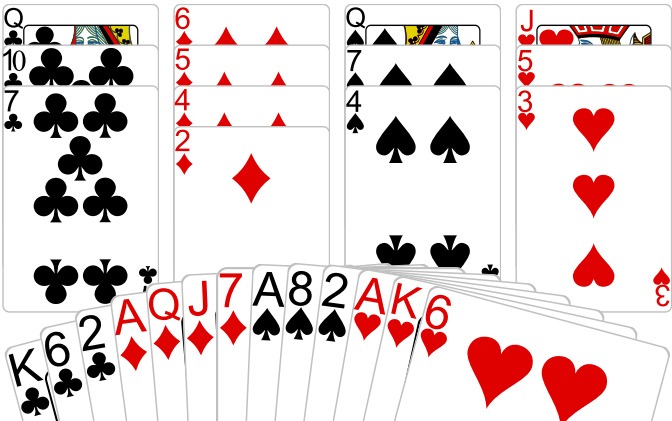


Deal 1 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 6 5 2

♥ 6 5 2

♦ A Q 7

♣ 9 4

♠ 8 3

♥ A K J 9 8 7

♦ K 10 4 3

♣ A



♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 3

♦ J 9 8 2

♣ 10 6 2

♠ 9

♥ Q 10 4

♦ 6 5

♣ K Q J 8 7 5 3

West

North

East

South

1♥

Pass

2♣

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

♦. If East plays a third ♠ you will ruff in your hand, then unblock the ♣A, then pull trumps in 3 rounds ending in dummy. And run all those ♣ tricks. If East plays a trump or a ♣ the result will be the same. The defense can get one ♦ trick if they take it right now, but you still make your contract.

It is an important concept. When you have to use a trump as a later entry you could thwart your own plan by ruffing.

North is to play 4♥. East leads the ♠A, then ♠K.

Losers: ♠ = 1 ♥ = 0 ♦ = 3? ♣ = 0 Total = 4?

This is the kind of hand that can get really messy if you aren't careful. You could ruff the ♠, then try to ruff some ♦s, but the defense can prevent you by leading trumps when you give up the ♦ tricks.

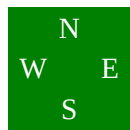
All in all a much better plan is to use dummy's ♣ suit after you unblock the Ace. The only flaw with that idea is that when you ruff the ♠, unblock the ♣A, then play two rounds of trumps ending in dummy, there will still be a trump left out. And the defender might ruff a ♣ before you can take the discards you need. Do you see a way around this?

Do NOT ruff the second ♠ in dummy, just discard a

Board 3
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q 7 4
♥ J 5 3
♦ 6 5 4 2
♣ Q 10 7

♠ K J 9
♥ 10 9 8 2
♦ K 9 3
♣ A 8 4



♠ A 8 2
♥ A K 6
♦ A Q J 7
♣ K 6 2

♠ 10 6 5 3
♥ Q 7 4
♦ 10 8
♣ J 9 5 3

West	North	East	South
		2NT	Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Assume North now plays a ♥. Take your ♥ A and play a ♣ to dummy's ♣10. Lead a ♦ and finesse the ♦ J, which holds. Play another ♣ to dummy and finesse another ♦. Now play your ♦ A and smile when the ♦ K drops and your fourth ♦ becomes a winner.

As soon as North put up the ♣ A you knew you could win 2 ♣ tricks.

By unblocking the ♣ K you were still pretty confident that you would get the two tricks, but the bonus was in the extra dummy entry your unblock created.

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♣ 3, North plays the ♣ A.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 6

You have the possibility of one additional ♠ winner if South holds the ♠ K. However, ♦s is your best suit and if North holds the ♦ K you could gain all three winners that you need from that suit. But of course you need perhaps 2 dummy entries. Do you have them?

Well, you probably do. South's small ♣ lead probably indicates an honor, and with North playing the ♣ A you can be pretty sure that South holds the ♣ J. So by playing your ♣ K underneath the ♣ A you set up a second entry to dummy via the ♣ finesse.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 5 2
♥ 10 8 5 3
♦ A J 9 5 2
♣ 6

♠ Q J
♥ A Q 6
♦ 8 4
♣ Q J 9 8 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 6 4
♥ 9 7 4 2
♦ Q 10 6
♣ K 7 4

♠ K 10 9 8 3
♥ K J
♦ K 7 3
♣ A 10 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
when East plays low. Play one more ♣ to your ♣A, picking up East's ♣K this time.

The ♣ suit is ready to run, so play your ♥K to dummy's ♥A and take your ♣ winners. You took 9 tricks in all, the ♦K, the ♥A Q and all 6 ♣s.

You started with 3 ♥ winners, but had to sacrifice one of them to get the second entry to dummy.

Since it gave you all 6 ♣ tricks the sacrifice was well worth it.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♦5, East plays the ♦Q.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=3 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 5

You must take the ♦K right now or you might lose the first 5 tricks.

It's a shame about that solid ♠ suit, but if you try to win even a single ♠ they will grab the ♠A and win enough ♦ tricks to set the contract.

So you are going to have to win a lot of ♣ tricks, and do so without losing the lead. You need dummy entries, and they must be in ♥s.

Win the ♦K. Play the ♥J to dummy's ♥Q. Play the ♣Q and when East follows with a low card let it ride. Still in dummy, play the ♣J, again letting it ride.